

SQL Joins Explained (Easy Guide)

In SQL, a JOIN is used to combine data from two or more tables using a common column (usually an ID). Below are the main types of joins used in databases.

1. INNER JOIN

Returns only the rows that have matching values in both tables.

2. LEFT JOIN (LEFT OUTER JOIN)

Returns all rows from the left table and matching rows from the right table. If there is no match, NULL values are returned for the right table.

3. RIGHT JOIN (RIGHT OUTER JOIN)

Returns all rows from the right table and matching rows from the left table. If there is no match, NULL values are returned for the left table.

4. FULL JOIN (FULL OUTER JOIN)

Returns all rows from both tables. If there is no match in either table, NULL values are used.

Quick Summary

Join Type	Meaning
INNER JOIN	Only matching rows
LEFT JOIN	All rows from left table + matching rows from right
RIGHT JOIN	All rows from right table + matching rows from left
FULL JOIN	All rows from both tables